All You Need to Know About the Tools *for* Blockchain Developers

Developers need to arm themselves with special tools when working on blockchain technology. Let us explore some of these tools that are useful for developers working on the Bitcoin or Ethereum networks.

Blockchain technology envisions a future of making every centralised process, activity and organisation fully autonomous. It is immutable, encrypted, decentralised and has the potential to eliminate intermediaries, authorities and any third-party intervention in all applications. No wonder blockchain developers are considered as real unicorns in the industry right now as a lot of companies, especially startups, are looking for their expertise. However, only a handful of them work on this technology today.

To work with blockchain technology you do not need to build a blockchain from scratch. You can use the already existing networks like Bitcoin, Ethereum or Hyperledger. While Bitcoin and Ethereum are both decentralised, open source and public, Hyperledger is private but open source. Both Bitcoin and Ethereum are different and you must choose between them based on your application. Ethereum is suitable for building decentralised applications (DApps) while Bitcoin is not really a good choice for DApps as it was designed for peer-to-peer transactions.

Blockchain as a Service

The main goal of Blockchain as a Service (BaaS) is to offer the backend capabilities needed by blockchain solutions. The BaaS offered by different companies supports several chains including MultiChain, Eris, Storj and Augur. One of the advantages of BaaS is that users can leverage the lessons learned by the service provider to make their system more secure. The key players offering BaaS are Microsoft, IBM, HP and Oracle.

Platforms for writing smart contracts

One of the most common languages used for writing smart contracts is Solidity, for which Solc is the compiler. Most of the Ethereum nodes natively include a Solc implementation but the latter is available as a separate module for offline compiling.

Another programming language used to write smart contracts is Serpent, for which the Ether scripter helps you to write the script or code. The latest version of the Serpent compiler is available on GitHub.

Testnet

Testnet is an alternative blockchain, the coins of which do not carry any value and are easy to obtain. These allow application developers to test their creations before taking